THE MONETARY EXPRESSION OF THE HARD-ASSET THESIS

# The Coupon That Stopped Mattering

For forty years the case against gold was a single sentence: it pays nothing, and something that pays nothing loses to something that pays. This August the something that pays got dearer than at any time since 2007 — the thirty-year Treasury cash yield reached 5.336% on 18 August — and gold rose anyway, climbing roughly 18% from its 30 June low to a three-month high of about $4,676 an ounce on 25 August. The old sentence did not merely fail to predict the move. It predicted the opposite.

The question is no longer whether gold is expensive. It is whether the thing that sets its price has changed hands.

### A reframe worth holding onto

The internal Wiki's central reframe, drawn from Russell Napier's Solid Ground of 18 August, is that gold is not arguing with the bond market — it is reading it. Rising developed-world yields arriving *alongside* a rising gold price means gold is seeing through the nominal yield to what Napier calls "an accelerated financial repression": a monetary order of managed capital flows and, over time, institutionalised negative real rates. On that reading a higher coupon is not competition for gold. It is the evidence for it. This is a view, not a forecast, and the Wiki labels it as such.

METHOD. External figures come from World Gold Council demand and ETF-flow publications, US Treasury auction results reported by CNBC, Bloomberg and the CRFB, company disclosures and dated market quotations; each carries an as-of date and is listed in full at the end. Internal figures and interpretations come from the Heyokha research Wiki page *Gold* (created 23 June 2026, last reviewed 21 August 2026) and the summaries feeding it; these are named providers' opinions, labelled as views. One conflict is worth flagging at the outset: aggregator reports of gold's 2026 peak vary widely, with one giving a spot record near $4,736 on 20 January — a figure that cannot be reconciled with a 6.7% year-to-date decline from a level near $4,676, where the COMEX futures series can. This edition uses the futures series and notes the discrepancy rather than resolving it.

Consider a landlord with two flats side by side. One is let; the other stands empty. Each year the rent on the let flat rises, which sounds like good news until the reason is examined: the tenant's income has stopped covering his outgoings, and he accepted the increase only because no other landlord would take him. The higher rent is not a reward for owning the flat. It is the price of a risk that has grown. The empty flat pays nothing at all, and on the arithmetic that has governed the last four decades it is plainly the inferior asset — one produces income, the other does not. But if enough buyers conclude the tenant will settle his debts in money worth less than the money he borrowed, the empty flat becomes the safer of the two, and bids appear for it even as the rent next door climbs. A thirty-year bond is the let flat. Gold is the empty one. This August, both went up.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

**$4,676**

Spot gold on 25 August 2026, a three-month high and the first move above $4,600 since 15 May. Gold is still down 6.7% this year, up 22.1% over twelve months.
*— Yahoo Finance / Fortune, 24–25 Aug 2026*

**5.336%**

The thirty-year Treasury cash yield on 18 August 2026, the highest since June 2007. Five days earlier a $25bn auction cleared at 5.216%, the highest since 2001.
*— US Treasury / CNBC / Bloomberg, Aug 2026*

**289t**

Central-bank gold purchases in the second quarter, a record for any Q2 and 74% higher year on year. Poland took 51 tonnes, China 33, while the price fell.
*— World Gold Council, 30 Jul 2026*

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

# A drawdown, then a divorce

Gold's 2026 has been two distinct markets wearing one name. The first ran from a 29 January peak of $5,626.80 on the COMEX contract to a 30 June low of $3,955.40 — a fall of 29.7%, the deepest drawdown of the entire cycle. The proximate cause was orthodox and easily narrated. A shock jobs report on 5 June killed expectations of Federal Reserve rate cuts; gold fell 3.27% that day and had erased its entire year-to-date gain by 11 June. Real rates were going up, so the asset that pays no coupon went down. The model worked.

The second market began on 1 July and has run in the opposite direction to the same inputs. Over the following eight weeks the long end of the Treasury curve repriced violently upward. A $42bn ten-year auction on 12 August cleared at 4.683%, the highest since 2007. The $25bn thirty-year auction the following day cleared at 5.216%, the highest since 2001, and the cash thirty-year reached 5.336% on 18 August. Gold, on the old arithmetic, should have made new lows. Instead it rose about 18% off the June bottom and traded above $4,700 in the week to 25 August.

What changed between the two markets was not the coupon. It was the reason for the coupon. In the first half, yields rose because the economy looked too strong for cuts. In the second, they rose while the labour data softened and inflation prints cooled — the July payroll number was negative, retail sales were weak, and the market moved from pricing a September rate rise to roughly a two-in-three chance of no move at all. Yields that rise on weak data are not pricing growth. They are pricing the borrower. That is a credit signal, not a rates signal, and gold responds to credit signals in the opposite direction to rates signals.

Underneath the price action, the composition of demand moved decisively. Central banks bought a record 289 tonnes in the second quarter, up 74% year on year, throughout the period when the price was falling hardest. Poland's National Bank took 51 tonnes of that and holds 632.4 tonnes as of July, roughly 30% of its total reserves, on the way to a stated 700-tonne target. The People's Bank of China took 33 tonnes, its largest quarterly addition since late 2023. Meanwhile Western investors left: North American gold ETFs recorded US$7.7bn of outflows in the first half, the region's weakest first half since 2013, and global ETF holdings stood at 4,068 tonnes in August against a record 4,176 tonnes set on 27 February. The buyer of last resort and the buyer of first resort swapped places.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

A real-rate model prices gold as a *competitor to a coupon*: the higher the coupon, the worse gold does. A credit model prices gold as a *claim on the issuer's failure*: the higher the coupon, the worse the issuer looks, and the better gold does. Both models are internally coherent. They differ only in what they assume the rising yield is telling them — and in 2026 they have pointed in opposite directions twice in six months.

MECHANISM

# How a tonne of sovereign demand moves the clearing price

**1. A mandate is set, not a trade**

A reserve manager concludes that another government's paper is a political instrument rather than a neutral store of value, and adopts a tonnage target. The decision is taken by a board on a multi-year horizon. It contains no price.

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**2. Execution ignores the tape**

Buying is worked over the counter, in size, across months, often into weakness. Poland added 51 tonnes in a quarter when the price fell; the PBOC has added in twenty consecutive months. Falling prices accelerate rather than deter the programme.

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**3. The metal leaves the float**

Sovereign bullion goes into a vault. It is not lent into the leasing market, not hedged, and does not return as supply at a higher price. The pool of metal available to clear day-to-day trading shrinks permanently.

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**4. The clearing price re-sets**

Western redemptions that would once have capped the price now meet a bid with no view on the real yield. The rate model still describes the flow it can see. It no longer describes the flow that clears.

Mechanism reconstructed from World Gold Council Q2 2026 Gold Demand Trends (30 July 2026), National Bank of Poland disclosures (July 2026), and the internal Wiki's characterisation of price-insensitive official-sector behaviour. Illustrative of the transmission channel; not a description of any particular transaction.

**289t**

Central-bank purchases in 2Q26 — a record for any second quarter, +74% year on year, and more than a five-fold increase on a revised first quarter. Poland 51t, China 33t, Uzbekistan 16t, Kazakhstan 15t. — *World Gold Council, 30 Jul 2026*

**−US$7.7bn**

North American gold ETF outflows in the first half of 2026 — the region's weakest first half since 2013. Western private capital was the seller into the official-sector bid, not the buyer alongside it. — *World Gold Council, H1 2026*

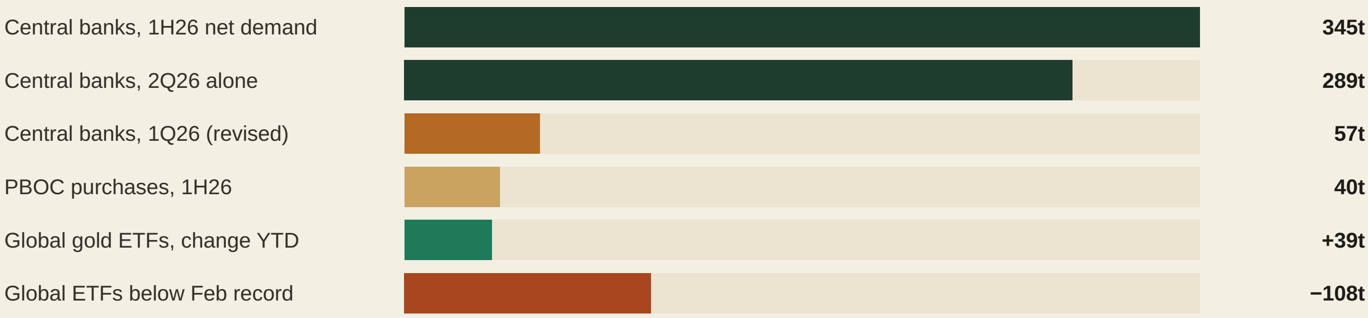
**345t**

Total central-bank net demand across the first half — the smallest first half since 2022, because the first-quarter figure was revised down 77% to 57 tonnes on OTC reclassification. The record quarter sits inside a weak half. — *World Gold Council; internal Wiki, Aug 2026*

Figures as reported by the World Gold Council for Q2 2026 (published 30 July 2026) and its monthly ETF flow series; the Q1 revision is recorded on the internal Wiki citing Greed & Fear of 6 August 2026.

THE COMPARISON THE ARGUMENT TURNS ON

# Official tonnes against private tonnes




Bars are illustrative and scaled to the 345-tonne half-year official figure; they are not drawn to a common statistical basis. Official-sector data from the World Gold Council (Q2 2026, published 30 July 2026); PBOC half-year figure from the internal Wiki citing 13D of 13 August 2026; ETF holdings of 4,068 tonnes in August against the record 4,176 tonnes of 27 February 2026 from World Gold Council ETF flow data.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

A price-insensitive buyer with a tonnage target is not a bull. It is a *floor-setter*. It converts a stream of political decisions into a boundary beneath the price, and boundaries do not generate returns — they change the shape of the distribution. The gain from a floor comes from what other people are willing to pay above it. On that reading, the official-sector bid explains why gold stopped falling in June. It does not, on its own, explain why gold should rise from here.

THE SHIFT

## What has actually shifted

| WHAT HAS CHANGED | WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA | WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS |
|---|---|---|
| **The marginal buyer** | A record 289 tonnes of official purchases in 2Q26 executed while the price fell, against US$7.7bn of North American ETF outflows in the same half. | A price-insensitive bid absorbs supply but does not chase. It should compress downside — and it caps upside for the same reason, because it stops buying no sooner than it started. |
| **The rate relationship** | Gold up roughly 18% from its 30 June low while the thirty-year cash yield reached 5.336% on 18 August, a high since June 2007. | Either the real-rate model has broken structurally, or gold is simply front-running the cuts that a debt-service burden of this size makes inevitable. The two readings share a direction now and diverge sharply on when to stop. |
| **The fiscal arithmetic** | US total public debt crossed US$40.05tn on 18 August; the ten-month FY26 deficit of US$1.799tn already exceeds the whole of FY25 (Greed & Fear, 20 Aug — a view). | Fiscal stress is the bull case's engine. It also raises the probability of the disorderly deflationary episode in which gold is sold first, because it is the position that can be sold. |
| **The official response** | The Treasury doubled its long-bond buyback cap from US$2bn to at least US$4bn per operation on 19 August; yields fell back to 4.63% and 5.18% on the news (Greed & Fear, 20 Aug — a view). | Yield suppression is precisely the repression the bull case anticipates. It is also proof the authorities retain effective tools, which postpones the reckoning the case is built on. |
| **Concentration of the bid** | Poland supplied 51 of the record 289 tonnes and now holds roughly 30% of its reserves in gold — the previous permitted ceiling — while the PBOC holds about 8% against a global average nearer 27%. | The gap between 8% and 27% is the runway. The fact that one buyer's mandate accounted for nearly a fifth of a record quarter is the fragility. Both facts describe the same concentration. |

BOTH SIDES

# Bull and bear, stated fairly

## The bull case

- **The official bid is structural, not opportunistic.** A record 289 tonnes in 2Q26, +74% year on year, bought through the worst of the drawdown; the PBOC has added in twenty consecutive months; Poland is running to a 700-tonne target (World Gold Council, 30 Jul 2026; NBP, Jul 2026).
- **The fiscal arithmetic has no benign exit.** Net interest plus entitlements reached 98.4% of federal receipts in the twelve months to July, the highest since June 2020 (Greed & Fear, 20 Aug 2026 — a view).
- **Rising yields now confirm rather than contradict.** Weak payrolls and cooling inflation stopped rallying the long end. Napier reads gold as seeing through nominal yields to an accelerated financial repression and institutionalised negative real rates (Solid Ground, 18 Aug 2026 — a view).
- **The float is tightening at the margin.** Official purchases exceeded the extrapolated annual gain in mine output, while first-half mine production rose only about 3% (13D, 13 Aug 2026 — a view).
- **Western under-ownership is potential energy.** North American ETFs had their weakest first half since 2013 and global holdings sit 108 tonnes below the February record. The private-sector bid has not arrived, so it cannot yet be a crowded trade (World Gold Council, Aug 2026).
- **Breadth turned in August.** 13D declares the correction over on multiplying breakouts across gold, silver and mining, flagged by the S&P/TSX Venture Composite clearing a twelve-year base, and reiterates a $8,000–10,000 target by 2030 (13D, 16 Aug 2026 — a view).

## The bear case

- **Gold is down 6.7% this year.** It fell 29.7% from the 29 January peak of $5,626.80 to a 30 June low of $3,955.40 — the deepest drawdown of the cycle — and it did so during the record official-buying quarter. The floor, if it exists, is a long way below the price.
- **The record quarter sits inside a weak half.** First-half official net demand of 345 tonnes was the smallest since 2022, because the first quarter was revised down 77% to 57 tonnes. A lumpy, frequently restated series produces headline records that describe accounting as much as behaviour.
- **The bid is concentrated and mandate-bound.** Poland alone was nearly a fifth of the record quarter and is already at roughly 30% of reserves, the level that was until recently its permitted ceiling. A mandate is a decision, and decisions reverse without warning to the tape.
- **The deflationary accident is the live risk.** Napier's own sequence puts a deflation shock *before* the repression. 13D concedes that a credit crunch — plausibly triggered by a bursting AI and data-centre capex cycle — would force gold selling, on the principle of selling what can be sold rather than what one wishes to sell (13D, 13 Aug 2026; Napier via CLSA, 14 Aug 2026 — views).
- **The house contains an explicit bear.** HS Dent models gold at $1,100–1,680 by 2028–29 in a debt deleveraging before any commodity-cycle rally. That is not a rounding error against 13D's $8,000–10,000; it is the same asset with a decimal point moved (internal Wiki, Jul 2026 — a view).
- **Gold is not even the house's first hedge.** Wood's conclusion on 20 August was that investors need to own oil and energy equities as the best hedge, "with gold second best," with the Strait of Hormuz effectively closed and the Nymex diesel crack above US$100/bbl for the first time (Greed & Fear, 20 Aug 2026 — a view).

Where the internal and external views genuinely conflict is on what the second quarter proved. 13D's 16 August conclusion — that the correction is over and the next major up-leg is underway — rests on the record 289-tonne quarter and on technical breadth. The externally published data supports a less comfortable reading of the same period: the half-year total of 345 tonnes was the weakest first half since 2022, Western investors were net sellers throughout, global ETF holdings remain 108 tonnes below their February record, and the metal is down 6.7% on the year. Both accounts use World Gold Council numbers. One emphasises the quarter, the other the half. This edition does not resolve which framing is right, because the resolution depends entirely on whether the third-quarter figure, due in late October, looks like 289 or like 57 — and that number does not exist yet.

THE DASHBOARD

# What to watch from here

| SIGNAL | PLAIN-ENGLISH READING | WHY IT MATTERS |
|---|---|---|
| **Warsh at Jackson Hole, Friday 28 August, 08:00 ET** | The Fed chair's first keynote in the role. Whether he acknowledges any fiscal constraint on policy, or restates price stability without a path. | The bull case requires a central bank that cannot raise rates because the sovereign cannot afford it. An explicit hawkish commitment with a credible path would damage that case directly. |
| **The ten-year Treasury at 5%** | Widely read as the Treasury Secretary's line in the sand; the ten-year was 4.69% in the week to 20 August. | Breaching it would test whether buybacks and repo facilities are a policy or a gesture. Holding it demonstrates that yield suppression works, which is bullish gold and bearish the urgency behind it. |
| **Q3 2026 central-bank purchases (World Gold Council, late October)** | Whether 289 tonnes was a run-rate or a peak distorted by one buyer and one reclassification. | This is the single number that arbitrates between the internal and external readings of the same half-year. Nothing else settles it. |
| **North American gold ETF flows** | Whether Western private capital returns after its weakest first half since 2013. | The official bid sets a floor. Only private demand has historically produced the parabolic phases. Its absence is either the opportunity or the verdict. |
| **Poland's reserve-composition ceiling** | Gold is near 30% of NBP reserves; the 700-tonne target implies roughly 38%. | Reaching the target requires the ceiling to move. If it does, other mandate-constrained buyers have a precedent. If it does not, a fifth of the record quarter's demand stops. |
| **The gold:silver ratio, about 68** | It fell below 45 in late January and has widened back to the high sixties; silver was $68.40 on 26 August, down about 9% this year. | A narrowing ratio driven by silver strength suggests industrial and speculative participation. A narrowing driven by gold weakness suggests the monetary bid is thinning. The direction of the fix matters more than the level. |

EXPRESSIONS

# Three postures, not one answer

### Own the metal; accept the carry

Allocated bullion or a redeemable physical trust. The position is the thesis without intermediation. The explicit cost is a permanent negative carry against a coupon now above 5%, storage and management fees, and full exposure to the deflation shock that Napier places before the repression — the scenario in which the thesis is eventually right and the position is closed first.

### Own the liquidity; accept the counterparty

A large physically backed ETF. Tight spreads, instant size, and the ability to be wrong cheaply. The explicit cost is that the holding is a claim within the paper system the thesis is partly a bet against, plus 0.25–0.40% a year — and, on Wood's endgame reading, exposure to a world in which paper gold trades at a discount to physical.

### Own the operating leverage; accept the beta

Producers or royalty companies, where a fixed cost base turns a gold move into a larger earnings move. The explicit cost is equity market beta, capital-allocation risk, and cost inflation — 13D put first-quarter all-in sustaining costs up 16% — plus the certainty of being sold in a liquidity event alongside everything else.

**The instruments and companies named below are illustrative of how the theme is expressed in listed markets. They are NOT recommendations, and nothing here constitutes investment advice or an offer to transact.**

## GLD

1,047.2t in trust
21 Aug 2026

**SPDR Gold Shares**

The largest and most liquid vehicle, with about US$172.7bn of assets and a 0.40% expense ratio. It holds allocated bars and creates or redeems in baskets against authorised participants. It is also the instrument through which Western investors expressed their exit this year: North American ETF outflows of US$7.7bn in the first half were largely worked through vehicles of this kind. Tonnage in trust is therefore a cleaner sentiment reading than the price.

**WATCH NEXT**

> Whether tonnes in trust turn up before the price does, or after it.

## IAU

0.25% expense ratio
Aug 2026

**iShares Gold Trust**

The cheaper of the two large US bullion trusts, with roughly US$60bn of assets against a 0.40% fee at the market leader. Over a multi-decade holding period intended to hedge monetary debasement, a fifteen-basis-point difference compounds into a material share of the position — an awkward arithmetic for an asset held precisely because it is not supposed to erode. The structure is otherwise closely comparable.

**WATCH NEXT**

> Whether asset growth continues to favour the cheaper vehicle as holding periods lengthen.

## PHYS

3.67m oz held
31 Jul 2026

**Sprott Physical Gold Trust**

A closed-end trust listed in New York and Toronto, holding about 3.67 million ounces, with a monthly right for unitholders to redeem for physical bullion subject to minimums. That redemption right is the structural answer to Wood's endgame — the scenario in which paper gold trades at a discount to metal. The cost of the structure is that the units trade at a premium or discount to net asset value, so the holder carries basis risk against the thing being hedged.

**WATCH NEXT**

> The premium or discount to NAV, which widens when physical is scarce.

## CMM AU

123,589oz FY26
31 Jul 2026

**Capricorn Metals**

Named on the internal Wiki as Chris Wood's global-portfolio gold-mining holding. FY26 output of 123,589 ounces landed at the top of guidance; the company closed the year with A$507m in cash and gold, no debt and no hedging. Mount Gibson's reserve rose 34% to 3.67 million ounces. Being unhedged is the point of owning it and also the risk: FY27 guidance of 137,000–147,000 ounces carries all-in sustaining costs of A$1,900–2,100, up sharply on FY26.

**WATCH NEXT**

> Commissioning of the Karlawinda expansion, begun in the first quarter of FY27.

## 5713 JP

¥176.3bn net profit
FY to 31 Mar 2026

**Sumitomo Metal Mining**

Named on the internal Wiki as the Japan-portfolio gold expression. Revenue of ¥1.74tn was up 9.3%, and profit attributable to owners reached ¥176.3bn with earnings per share of ¥649.55 against ¥59.99 a year earlier — a recovery driven mostly by record copper prices and the absence of prior-year impairments. Hishikari, Japan's only commercially producing gold mine, is running toward 3.5 tonnes a year, with 1.1 tonnes sold in the June quarter. The gold exposure is real but small relative to copper and nickel.

**WATCH NEXT**

> Whether gold's contribution grows enough to matter against the copper cycle.

## SLV

Silver $68.40/oz
26 Aug 2026

**iShares Silver Trust**

The higher-beta, industrially exposed version of the same monetary bet. Silver is down about 9% in 2026 and the gold:silver ratio has widened from below 45 in late January to roughly 68 — inside its long-run 50–80 band but well above the 59.65:1 mean-reversion level identified in the Silver Institute study recorded on the internal Wiki, which finds that gold historically does the correcting. Silver carries the monetary bid and an industrial demand cycle simultaneously, which is why it moves further in both directions.

**WATCH NEXT**

> Whether the ratio narrows on silver strength or on gold weakness.

# The bottom line

What was repriced this August was not gold's value. It was the identity of the price-setter. For four decades the marginal buyer of gold was a Western investor running a real-rate calculation, and the metal behaved accordingly — including in the first half of this year, when it fell 29.7% on exactly that logic. Since July the marginal buyer has been an official reserve manager executing a tonnage mandate that contains no price, and the metal has risen 18% into a nineteen-year high in long-bond yields. The coupon has not stopped existing. It has stopped mattering to the buyer who clears the market.

The evidence is mixed and should be held that way. The record 289-tonne quarter sits inside the weakest first half of official demand since 2022; the technical breakouts sit under a price still 6.7% lower on the year; and the house that reiterates $8,000–10,000 by 2030 also contains a forecaster modelling $1,100–1,680 by 2029 and a strategist who ranks energy above gold as the hedge of choice. The reasonable inference is narrower than either camp would like: the official bid has established a floor, and a floor is worth something, but the return above it depends on private capital that has spent this year leaving. The next test is specific and dated — the third-quarter demand figures in late October, and before them, Kevin Warsh at the podium on Friday morning.



# Sources and update notes

**(a) Internal.** Primary page: *Gold* (type: theme; created 23 June 2026; last reviewed 21 August 2026; 18,928 words), sections Thesis, Mechanism — why it holds, What would change it, The bear case & what breaks it, Evidence & data, Contradictions, and the dated 2026 evolution sections. Provider issues relied upon, each with its publication date: **Greed & Fear, "40 trillion and counting," 20 August 2026** (US public debt US$40.05tn on 18 August; ten-month FY26 deficit US$1.799tn; net interest plus entitlements 98.4% of receipts; the August auction and cash yields cited above; buyback cap doubled 19 August; "oil and energy stocks as the best hedge, with gold second best"). **Solid Ground, "The Shock Of 26: It's The Political Economy, Stupid," 18 August 2026** (gold seeing through yields to accelerated financial repression; bonds as "certificates of confiscation"). **13D WATMTU, "Animal Spirits Return to the Mining Sector," 16 August 2026** (correction over; CDNX twelve-year base breakout). **13D WILTW, 13 August 2026** (Q2 official buying against a ~211-tonne extrapolated supply gain; PBOC twenty consecutive months, +40t in H1; gold 8% of PBOC stated reserves against a ~27% global average; H1 mine production +3%, Q1 AISC +16%; $8,000–10,000 by 2030; "sell what you can, not what you want"). **CLSA Bits & Pieces, 14 August 2026** (Degussa shadow gold price; Napier's deflation-shock-first sequence). **Greed & Fear, 6 August 2026** (Q1 official demand revised down 77% to 56.5t; 1H26 345.4t, the smallest first half since 2022). **HS Dent / Harry Dent, July 2026** (gold $1,100–1,680 by 2028–29). **Marc Faber monthly report, July 2026** (gold "slowly entering a buying zone"). **Silver Institute ratio study, 21 July 2026** (mean reversion to 59.65:1, with gold doing the correcting).

**(b) Limitation on the internal view.** The Gold page is heavily provider-concentrated. Of the roughly 130 source summaries listed in its frontmatter, the large majority are 13D Research WILTW and WATMTU issues, with a secondary cluster of Greed & Fear and a smaller Solid Ground group. 13D maintains an explicit strategic overweight — the internal record puts gold, silver and mining at 36.1% of its Highest Conviction Ideas allocation — so its coverage volume is not independent of its position. The bearish material on the page is thin by comparison and comes almost entirely from two named dissenters, Harry Dent and Marc Faber, neither of whom is a primary contributor. For that reason the bear case in this edition was built substantially from external reporting and from tensions inside the World Gold Council's own data, rather than from the Wiki's bear section, which is largely a set of conditional headings with little supporting evidence attached.

**(c) External sources.** (1) World Gold Council, *Gold Demand Trends Q2 2026*, published 30 July 2026 — central-bank purchases of 289 tonnes, +74% year on year and more than five times a revised Q1 of 57 tonnes; Poland 51t, China 33t, Uzbekistan 16t, Kazakhstan 15t, Jordan 6t, Czech Republic 6t; H1 net demand 345t, the lowest first half since 2022. (2) World Gold Council gold ETF flows, August 2026 — global holdings 4,068 tonnes, below the record 4,176 tonnes of 27 February 2026; year-to-date inflows of US$11bn equal to +39 tonnes; North American H1 outflows of US$7.7bn, the region's weakest first half since 2013; May outflows of 16 tonnes. (3) Yahoo Finance and Fortune, 24–25 August 2026 — spot gold $4,675.96 at 16:34 EDT on 25 August, a three-month high, with the first move above $4,600 since 15 May and an intraday peak above $4,700. (4) Market performance data, late August 2026 — gold down 6.7% year-to-date and up 22.1% over twelve months; COMEX futures record of $5,626.80 on 29 January 2026 followed by a 29.7% decline to a 30 June low of $3,955.40; a 3.27% single-day fall on 5 June that erased the year's gain. (5) CNBC, 18 August 2026 — thirty-year Treasury yield above 5.33%, a nineteen-year high. (6) Committee for a Responsible Federal Budget and Bloomberg, 13–14 August 2026 — the US$25bn thirty-year auction clearing at 5.216%, the highest since 2001, on a bid-to-cover of 2.39 with primary dealers taking 11.5%. (7) Notes From Poland, MarketPulse and Kitco, January–July 2026 — NBP holdings of 632.4 tonnes as of July, roughly 30% of reserves, up from 28% at end-2025, against a 700-tonne target that would imply about 38%, and a prior permitted ceiling of 30%. (8) Bloomberg, XTB and Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City materials, 21–22 August 2026 — the Jackson Hole symposium runs 27–29 August with Kevin Warsh's first keynote as chair on Friday 28 August at 08:00 ET; Warsh took office on 22 May 2026. (9) Vantage Markets and BBH, 22–24 August 2026 — the dollar index at 98.55 on 22 August, its lowest since May, with roughly a two-in-three market probability of a September hold. (10) State Street Global Advisors and ETF Database, August 2026 — GLD holdings of 1,047.21 tonnes as of 21 August, assets of US$172.71bn, expense ratio 0.40%; IAU expense ratio 0.25% on roughly US$60bn of assets. (11) Sprott, 31 July 2026 — PHYS holding 3,671,782 ounces with monthly physical redeemability. (12) Capricorn Metals ASX releases and The Motley Fool Australia, 31 July 2026 — FY26 production of 123,589 ounces, A$507m in cash and gold, no debt and no hedging, Mount Gibson reserve up 34% to 3.67 million ounces, FY27 guidance of 137,000–147,000 ounces at AISC of A$1,900–2,100. (13) Sumitomo Metal Mining results for the year to 31 March 2026 and Q1 FY2026 — revenue ¥1,741,586m (+9.3%), profit attributable to owners ¥176,290m, EPS ¥649.55 against ¥59.99, Hishikari targeting 3.5 tonnes a year with 1.1 tonnes sold in the June quarter. (14) Trading Economics and GoldSilver, 26 August 2026 — silver at $68.40 an ounce, down about 9% year-to-date, with the gold:silver ratio near 68 after falling below 45 in late January.

**(d) Editorial choices in this automated run.** Topic selection ran the standard hot-first scan over Wiki sources published since 5 August 2026, scoring entities three points inside three days, two inside seven and one inside twenty-one, with three bonus points for appearing in a source title. Gold scored highest among eligible active themes not on the thirty-day cooldown list, on the strength of Greed & Fear of 20 August, 13D of 16 and 13 August, and the CLSA "gold's shadow price" edition of 14 August. The cooldown check was performed by reading the HB Wiki Learning archive folder directly rather than through the remote-devices bridge, and it parsed cleanly: nineteen topics were excluded, among them Gold Miners (5 August), Copper (18 and 19 August), Fiscal Dominance (20 August), China Equities (21 August), Memory Supercycle (24 August), Rare Earth Magnets (25 August) and Humanoid Robots (26 August). Two consequences should be stated plainly. First, an edition already exists for today's date — Humanoid Robots, written earlier this morning — so this is a second edition for 26 August rather than the day's only one. Second, Gold sits close to Gold Miners, covered twenty-one days ago; the topics are distinct on the Wiki, which explicitly scopes mining equities to a separate page, and this edition has been written about bullion and the monetary bid rather than about producers, but the adjacency is real and is noted here rather than concealed. No tool failures occurred: the Wiki MCP server, the archive folder and web search all responded. The one data problem encountered was the conflicting external record of gold's 2026 peak, described in the method note above and left unresolved.

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